

Common Shallow Sponges of St. Thomas, USVI

Photos by Deborah Gochfeld, IDs by D. Gochfeld & M. Cristina Diaz

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NOAA
CORAL REEF
CONSERVATION PROGRAM



***Monanchora arbuscula*:**
Red encrusting, red vein-like canals, transparent white membrane, few large oscules



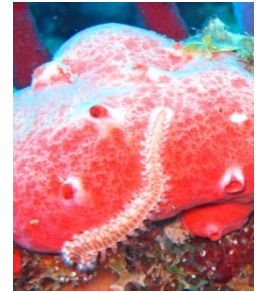
***Clathria venosa*:**
Grey encrusting, few large oscules at center of star-like clear canal pattern, many tiny pores



***Clathria curacaoensis*:**
Yellow-orange, thinly encrusting over dead coral or in holes, oscules at centers of star-like canal pattern



***Scopalina ruetzleri*:**
Yellow-orange, thin encrusting, soft, pointed peaks due to visible underlying skeletal features, large oscules



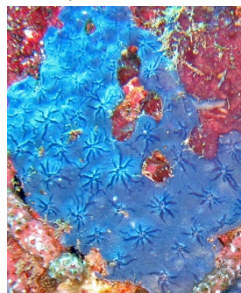
***Spirastrella coccinea*:**
Red or pink with darker specks, encrusting, leathery, vertical surfaces or in holes, small oscules with clear or white collars



***Spirastrella hartmani*:**
Red, pink or orange, encrusting, filmy elevated clear canals radiate from large oscules



***Chondrilla caribensis*:**
Mustard brown, thin smooth encrusting, rubbery, can cover large areas, paler oscules may have star pattern



***Halisarca caerulea*:**
Blue to lavender, thin leathery encrusting, tiny pores, oscules at center of star-like canals



***Neopetrosia proxima*:**
Brown, tan interior, thick crust to upright branching, hard but crumbly, small dispersed oscules



***Neopetrosia dendrocrevacea*:**
Brick to mustard brown, tan interior, crumbly, thick encrusting, bumpy surface with small cones that hold oscules



***Cliona delitrix*:**
Bright orange, bores into coral, round papillae, few large complex oscules with collar



***Niphates erecta*:**
Grey, purple or blue, thick encrusting or upright branches, rough surface, spongy, small oscules often have zoanthids



***Niphates digitalis*:**
Blue-grey, vase, small projections on surface, spiny rim with clear membrane, small oscules inside, may have zoanthids



***Aplysina cauliformis*:**
Purple, grey, or brown, thin tough branches can form thickets, small oscules, also thicker more rigid morphs



***Aplysina fulva*:**
Yellow, thin soft branches can form thickets if large, scattered oscules, blue exudate if handled



***Aplysina insularis*:**
Yellow, solitary or groups of tubes with large oscules, thin projections, soft, blue exudate if handled



***Aplysina archeri*:**
Lavendar, solitary or groups of tubes with large oscules, smooth or bumpy surface, tough



***Amphimedon compressa*:**
Maroon to bright red, thick, compressible, encrusting or branches, oscules can have elevated rims, red exudate if squeezed



***Amphimedon complanata*:**
Black erect branches or small lumps, compressible but hard to tear, smooth, small oscules, dark exudate if squeezed



***Hyrtios proteus*:**
Black massive with bumpy surface, tan interior, compressible but hard to tear, no exudate, small oscules if any